SARAH WISNER

IMPLEMENTATION & LABORATORY OPERATIONS

Dallas-Fort Worth, TX | Email | LinkedIn | Portfolio

Professional Summary

Implementation and laboratory operations professional with 7+ years of experience across regulated microbiology, quality systems, LIMS implementation, workflow design, technical training, and continuous improvement. Known for learning complex systems quickly, translating technical requirements into practical processes, and helping teams adopt tools that improve traceability, consistency, and operational efficiency. Combines hands-on laboratory expertise with systems thinking, stakeholder coordination, and people-centered implementation.

Core Expertise

Implementation & Systems

LIMS implementation and configuration • Requirements gathering • Workflow mapping • UAT and validation • Deployment, adoption, and hypercare • Vendor and stakeholder collaboration

Operations & Quality

Laboratory operations • ISO readiness • SOP development • Root-cause analysis • CAPA support • Process improvement • Equipment, inventory, and traceability controls

People & Change

Technical translation • Training and onboarding • Change management • Servant leadership • Cross-functional communication • User support and adoption planning

Technical & Analytical

Environmental monitoring platforms • Advanced Excel • HTML/CSS • JSON and API concepts • PCR/RT-PCR • Quantitative microbiology • Data analysis and reporting

Professional Experience

Foodservice Organization | Internal Food Safety & Quality Laboratory | Dallas–Fort Worth, TX — 2024-Present

Laboratory Lead

- Lead day-to-day laboratory operations, coordinate team priorities, and support timely, accurate work within a regulated food microbiology environment.
- Serve as co-lead subject matter expert and primary customer-success contact for a LIMS and a supporting environmental monitoring platform, coordinating requirements, configuration, testing, troubleshooting, vendor communication, and post-launch support.
- Translate laboratory and quality workflows into practical system designs, role-based training, and repeatable processes that support adoption across laboratory, quality, portal, and IT user groups.
- Designed, proofed, or optimized 8+ sample- and test-level worksheets, along with print documents, labels, reports, and email templates that reduce manual work and strengthen traceability.
- Created and narrated 20+ training videos and developed onboarding resources used across laboratory, quality, field, and IT teams; trained 5+ laboratory technicians in core technical skills and revised procedures.
- Apply HTML/CSS and working knowledge of JSON, JavaScript concepts, and API behavior to troubleshoot system behavior, improve usability, and communicate reproducible issues to vendor support and development teams.
- Lead ISO readiness activities including SOP review and rewrite, standardized templates, digital logs, equipment and inventory workflows, consultant coordination, and cross-functional scope tracking.
- Facilitate process-improvement work by assessing current-state workflows, identifying redundant controls or support gaps, and coordinating practical future-state solutions with stakeholders.
- Selected for early LIMS planning and requirements discussions involving workflow mapping, customer portal needs, security, file parsers, APIs, and instrument-result transfer.

Foodservice Organization | Internal Food Safety & Quality Laboratory | Dallas–Fort Worth, TX — Apr 2021-2024

Laboratory Technician

- Performed independent quantitative microbiology and RT-PCR testing across raw and finished foods, meat, dairy, powders, and environmental samples while managing accessioning, reporting, media preparation, inventory, and quality documentation.
- Managed quality-control sample randomization, login, and supporting documentation, developing a detailed understanding of cross-department user needs and laboratory-to-quality workflows.
- Cross-trained across laboratory operations and supported continuous-improvement initiatives before promotion to Laboratory Lead.
- Managed sample accessioning, test setup, result entry, reporting, and quality documentation within a legacy LIMS environment.

ISO-Accredited Third-Party Food Testing Laboratory | Seattle, WA — Jun 2020–Apr 2021

Microbiology Laboratory Technician

- Performed high-throughput food microbiology testing supporting hundreds of samples per day while maintaining quality and turnaround expectations.

- Executed 100+ qualitative and quantitative methods using FDA BAM, USDA, ISO, and AOAC-aligned procedures across pathogen, indicator-organism, and environmental testing.
- Conducted PCR, gel electrophoresis, enrichment, confirmation, quantitative plating, Agar/Petrifilm/Microfilm, MPN, and environmental testing; trained new personnel while independently managing workflow.

Washington State University | Pullman, WA — **Jan 2019–May 2020**

Undergraduate Research Assistant

- Conducted microbiology and molecular biology research involving Borrelia and Anaplasma phagocytophilum.
- Performed TRIzol RNA extraction, PCR, mammalian cell culture, infected tick colony maintenance, and molecular analysis.
- Independently led a research project investigating immune-gene silencing within tick cells.

Education

Washington State University — Pullman, WA — 2015–2020

Bachelor of Science, Dual Major: Microbiology (Laboratory Technician Option) | Cell Biology and Genetics

Certifications & Professional Development

Lean Six Sigma Green Belt Certification (2022) • bioMérieux GENE-UP Training Certificate (2025) • Neogen Petrifilm Training Certificate (2024) • Hygiena BAX PCR Training Certificate (2022)

Meat Institute Listeria Workshop (2024) • A2LA Annual Conference (2025)

Additional Technical & Laboratory Expertise

Systems & collaboration: Cloud-Based LIMS, environmental monitoring platforms, customer portals, workflow configuration, requirements gathering, process mapping, user adoption, change management, vendor collaboration, project coordination, Excel, SharePoint, Teams, Microsoft Copilot

Quality & regulatory: ISO readiness, SOP development, CAPA and operational logs, inventory/equipment traceability, FDA BAM, USDA and USP methods, root-cause analysis

Laboratory methods: PCR/RT-PCR, gel electrophoresis, aseptic technique, environmental monitoring, quantitative plating, Petrifilm/Microfilm, MPN, pathogen confirmation, limited flow-cytometry exposure

Applied Generative AI: ChatGPT and Microsoft Copilot for context design, workflow analysis, technical translation, documentation, iterative problem-solving, and output validation.